



BlackBerry's „Productivity Edge“ lives on – as an open-source rebuild for any Android phone. This guide shows what the panel does and how to set it up.

Version 1.4 · GNU GPLv3 · no BlackBerry code, only open Android interfaces

Source & APK: github.com/8818freak/EdgeTab

All screenshots from real use – personal names and content have been redacted.

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1 What is EdgeTab?

A slim, tapered handle sits at the screen edge (left or right) – just like the original. Tapping or pulling it out opens a panel of cards: calendar, inbox, SMS, calls, contacts, tasks, notes, app widgets, shortcuts, media controls and “Active Frames”, without leaving the app you’re in. **EdgeTab** rebuilds this from scratch – only public, documented Android interfaces (notification access, calendar/contacts providers, SMS/call log, AppWidgetHost, MediaSessionManager, JTX Board for tasks).

Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no data collection. Runs in German and English (automatically, by device language) and on any Android device from version 10 – no BlackBerry device needed.

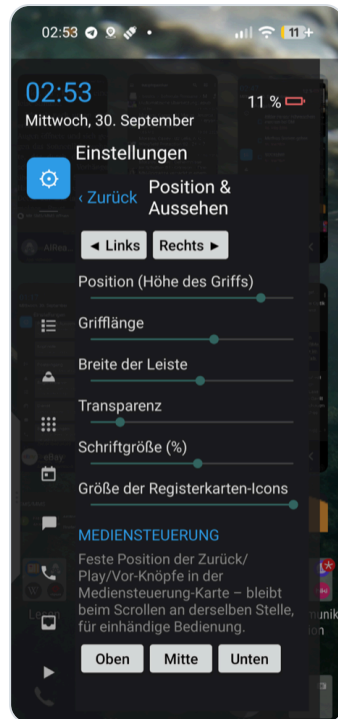
2 The edge handle

Tap or pull to open the panel; swipe back or tap beside it to close. Height, vertical position, width and transparency of the panel are freely adjustable – all under “Position & appearance”.

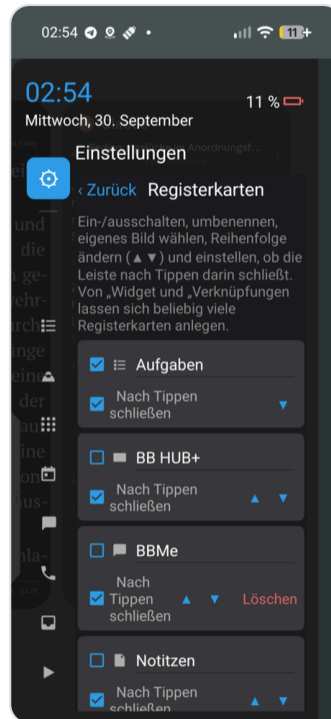
3 Settings & managing cards

The settings tab sits at the top of the card column, split into short sections (Position & appearance, Header, Inbox, Tabs, Permissions, Service, About EdgeTab). Changes take effect immediately, without a restart.

Every card can be toggled, renamed, given its own icon (gallery or bundled) and moved with ▲▼. You can add as many “Widget”, “Shortcuts”, “Media controls”, “SMS”, “Calls” and “Active Frames” cards as you like.



Settings: position & appearance

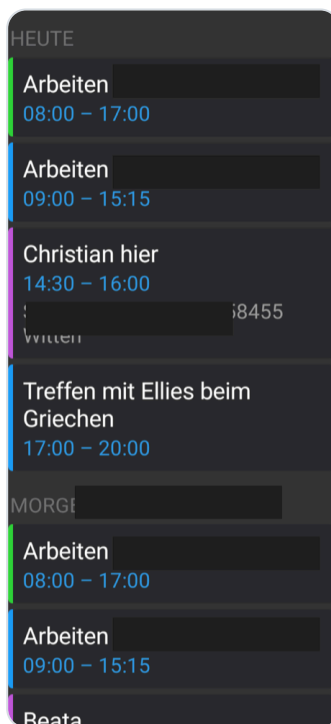


Managing tabs

4 The cards

Calendar

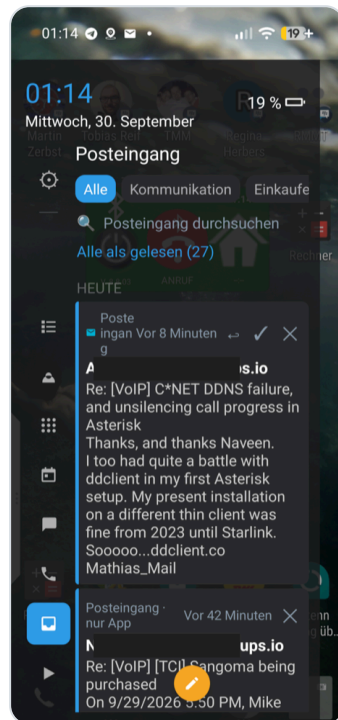
The next 7 days, grouped by day; tapping opens the event, the floating button opens the “new event” screen of the installed calendar app.



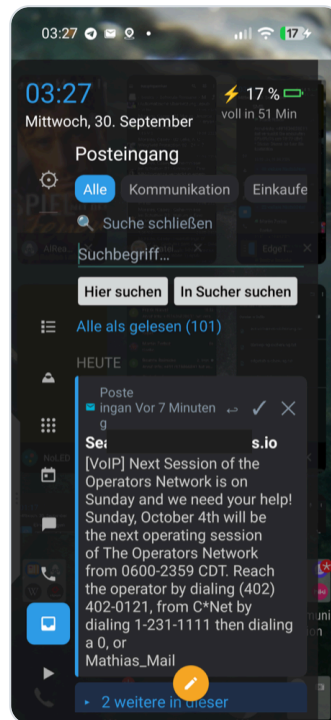
Calendar card

Inbox

Reads intercepted notifications from chosen source apps (works well with BlackBerry Hub, Telegram, Signal ...), grouped by day. Reply (via the notification's action, with or without inline text), mark-as-read and delete trigger the real action in the source app – and stay available even after the notification has left the status bar. Every notification is stored losslessly; a reply you send stays underneath as a small history. Categories colour and filter the inbox. The magnifier searches the inbox; “Search in Sucher” opens a full-text search across everything.



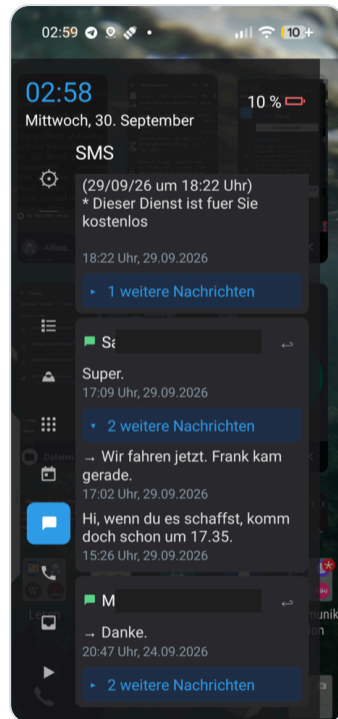
Inbox with inline reply



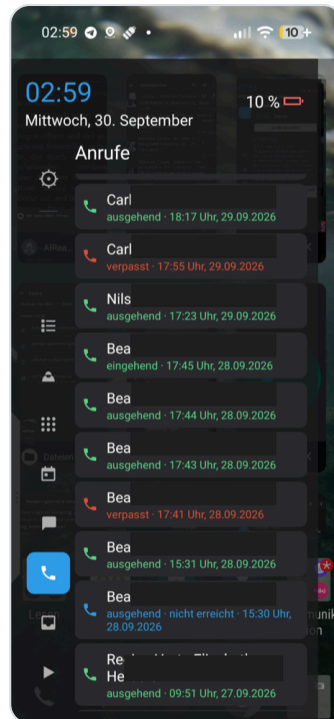
Search in the inbox

SMS & calls

SMS and calls come as their own cards – and optionally right in the inbox. SMS are grouped per contact into an **expandable conversation**, with **inline reply** from the panel. Calls show name/number, direction and time, colour-coded: green = successful, red = missed, blue = failed (outgoing, reached no one); missed calls can be marked as seen. Both cards have their own search (name/number/text) plus “Search in Sucher”. Requires the SMS and call-log permissions (on demand).



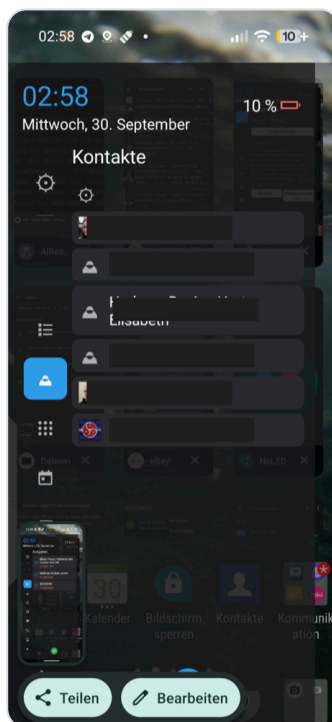
SMS as a conversation



Calls (colour-coded)

Contacts

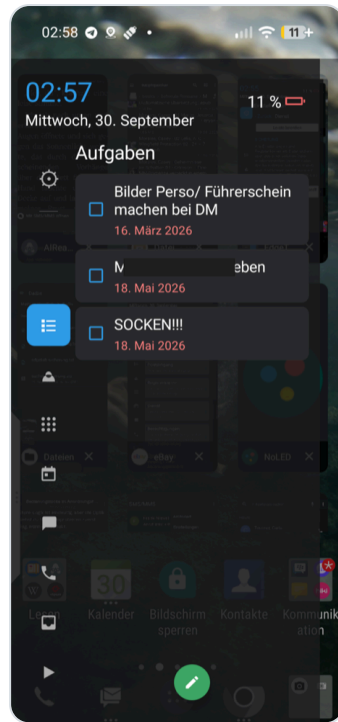
All contacts, a hand-picked subset or favourites only; name display and sorting configurable separately.



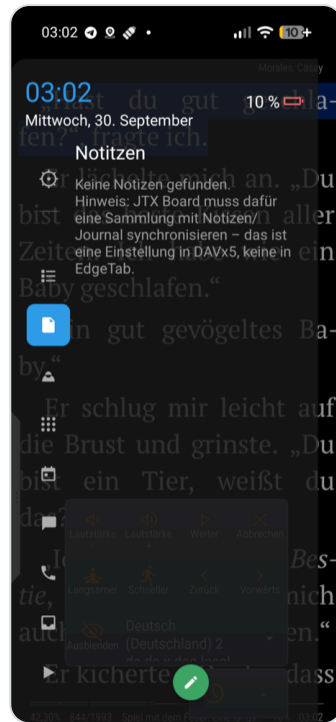
Contacts card

Tasks & notes

Tasks reads (and checks off) from **JTX Board**, which itself syncs via DAVx⁵/CalDAV with any server. The note button hands new notes to ImapNotes3.



Tasks (JTX Board)

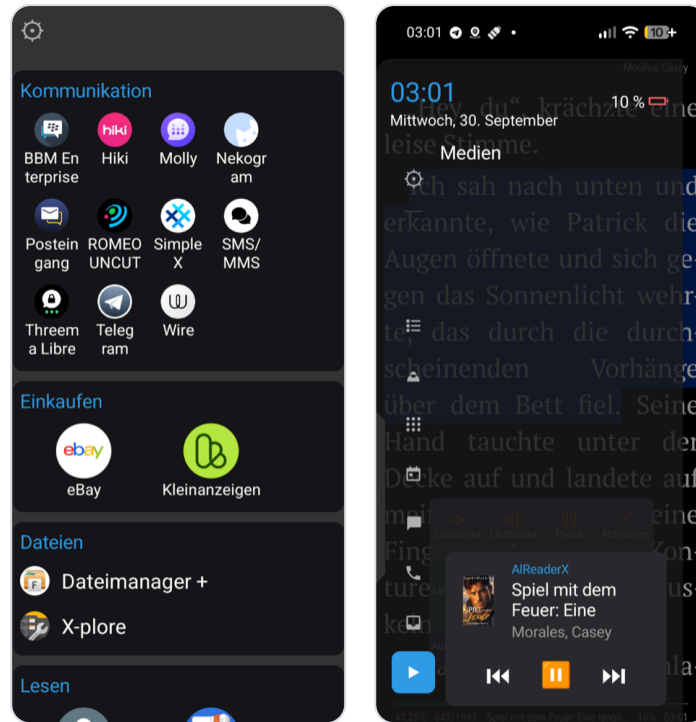


Notes card

Shortcuts, widgets & media controls

Shortcuts is a pure app launcher – sortable into freely named groups, each group a grid or list. Widget cards embed any installed app widget (e.g. the real Hub inbox widget). Media controls show and control active playback, with fixed-position quick buttons (top/middle/bottom).

Note on foreign widgets: some app widgets (e.g. the Hub inbox widget) embed poorly and can crash the **other app** – that is a bug in the other app, not in EdgeTab. EdgeTab only drives an embedded widget while its card is actually open. If a widget still causes trouble, **remove it from the card** (“Remove”) – merely disabling the tab is not a reliable off switch.

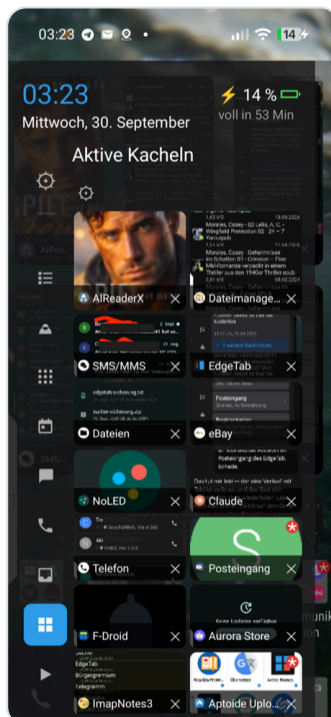


Shortcuts, grouped

Media controls

Active Frames (Widget 2)

A native “Active Frames” card: the most recently used apps as scrollable tiles, with a red star and app image/logo. It gets its data from the **Active Frames** app over a secured data channel – EdgeTab needs no extra permissions for it. Because the panel draws the tiles itself, the card always scrolls reliably.

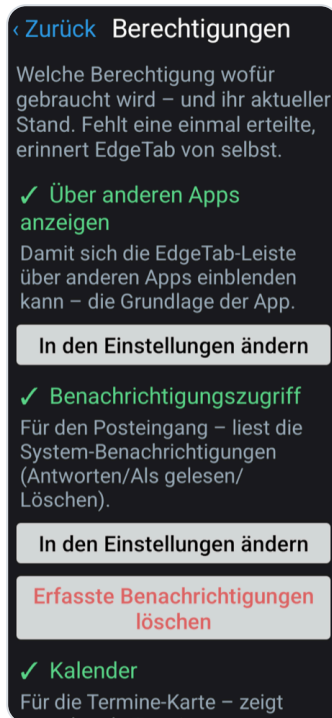


Active Frames

5 Permissions

A dedicated card lists every permission, what it is for and its status; a tap jumps to the matching system setting. If a once-granted permission goes missing (e.g. after an OS update), EdgeTab reminds you with a message that leads straight to re-granting and can be “ignored”. The inbox can also be cleared here.

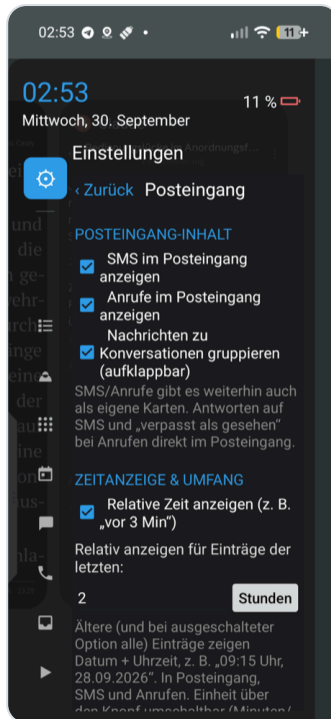
Important when a permission changes: if a permission changes – e.g. an update adds a new one or widens an existing one – you must **revoke the already-granted permission in Android settings and grant it again**. Otherwise it stays ineffective even though it shows as “granted”.



Permissions explained

6 Time display & scope

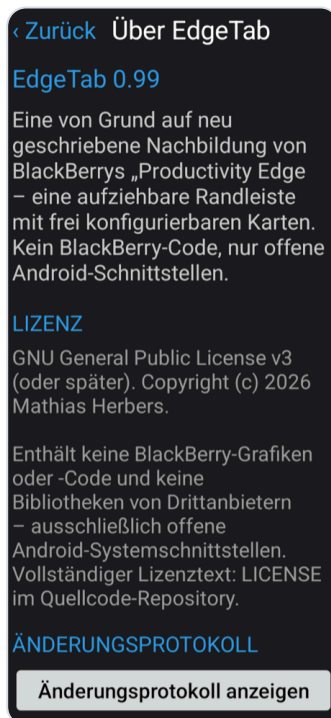
Under “Inbox” you can set whether, and up to what age, entries show relative time (“3 min ago”) instead of date + time – in minutes, hours or days. Likewise the list length by age in days (0 = all), so even long conversations appear in full.



Time display & scope

7 Crash safety & error log

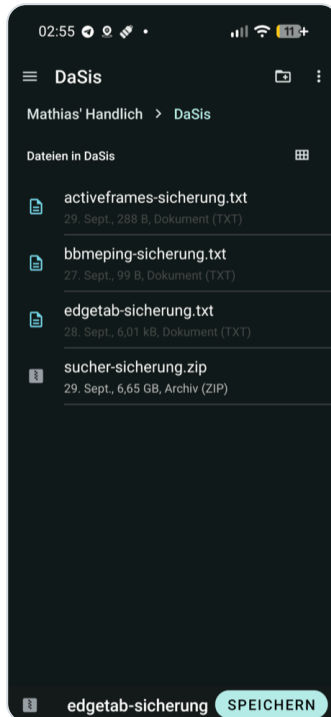
If EdgeTab crashes, the service restarts automatically (so the edge panel doesn't disappear). The error is saved to a log and shown under "About EdgeTab" – only if a crash actually happened, with a button to clear it.



About EdgeTab (version, licence, log)

8 Backup & restore

Backup writes settings and cards (order, names, icons, widget/shortcut assignments) **and the data** – the whole inbox history – as a single Zip file. “Restore” brings both back, via the system file dialog, without any storage permission. Older plain-text backups are still recognised.



Backup & restore